

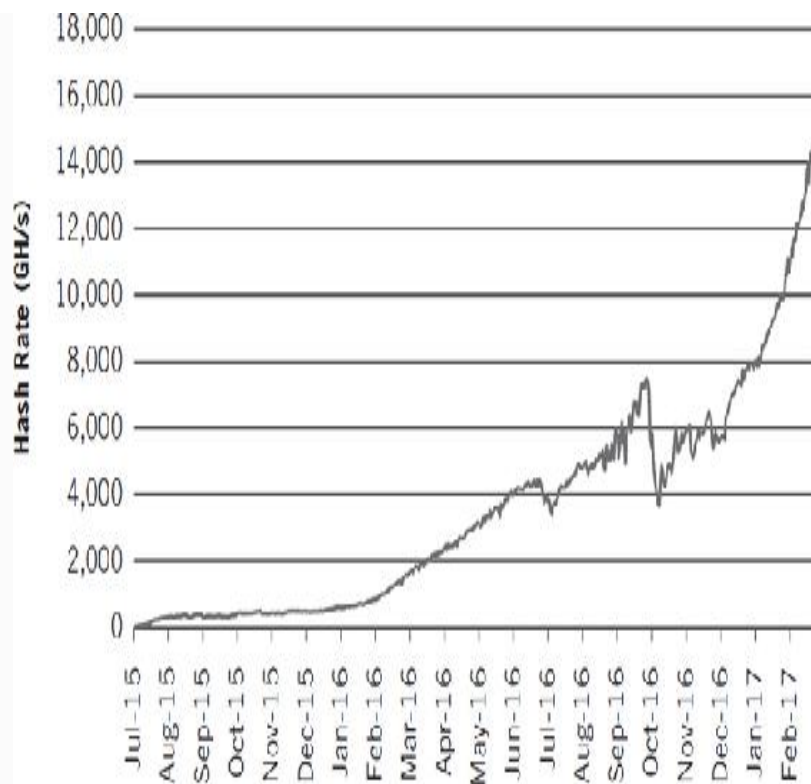


Figure 13.2 ■ Ethereum's hash rate rise since inception
Data sourced from Etherscan.io

As of March 2017, Bitcoin's hash rate had increased 3-fold over March 2016, while Ethereum's hash rate had increased 10-fold. While Ethereum is experiencing faster growth, which could be taken as a sign that more miners are enthusiastic about their potential profits from supporting Ethereum, it is also growing off a smaller initial hash rate than Bitcoin.

At the risk of being repetitive, more hash rate signifies more computers are being added to support the network, which signifies greater security. This typically only happens if the value of the cryptoasset and its associated transactions are increasing, because miners are profit-driven individuals. While hash rate often follows price, sometimes price can follow hash